

Truth Seekers: Axis of Distortion

An escape-room-style game that uses data visualizations as its puzzles, so students engage with charts and learn to read them along the way. The setting is St. Pölten in 1945, at the end of the Second World War. Elli's fiancé has been arrested, and the players help her trace him through the system by solving puzzles built around data visualizations.

Target age	16–18
Group size	4–5
Run time	45–60 minutes
Puzzles	6, played in fixed order
Core skills	Reading data visualizations, critical thinking, and problem-solving
Language	English & German

1. Materials Checklist

Printables

- Puzzle 1: Security report with the line chart [Page 1.1]
- Puzzle 2: Four patrol reports [Pages 2.1–2.4] and the main map [Page 2.5]
- Puzzle 3: Propaganda pamphlet with the four pie charts; markings indicate where to fold [Page 3.1]
- Puzzle 4: Box-plot grid [Page 4.1]
- Puzzle 5: Sankey transport report [Page 5.1]
- Puzzle 6: Three intelligence documents (Page 6.1 connections graph, Page 6.2 unit-deployment map, Page 6.3 armor bar chart)
Plus, the transfer registry [7.1] for the last input.

Equipment:

- Pens and at least one marker, spare paper for notes, and a calculator for the box-plot puzzle
- The accompanying website to submit solutions — requires 1× laptop or desktop PC per group

2. Using the Website

The website hosts the narrative scenes. Each scene explains what to do and asks for the solution in a set format - a correct answer unlocks the next scene.

A "Page needed" plaque (top-left) shows which printable the scene requires.

Each puzzle has three tiered hints, delivered through Elli (bottom-left of the screen). Tapping her opens the clue panel: the first hint reframes the problem, the second points to the mechanism, and the third brings players close to the solution. They unlock one at a time. The later hints stay locked until the earlier one has been opened, so a stuck group can nudge itself forward without being handed the answer.

WARNING NEXT PAGE CONTAINS SPOILERS AND PUZZLE ANSWERS!

UNCOVER AT YOUR OWN DISCRESSION.

If you intend on being a game master instead of playing that information will be helpful for navigating the players. However, that page isn't needed for completing the game as there are clues and solutions in the website as well.

3. Room Setup & Flow

Puzzles are played in a fixed sequence. Players submit each answer on the website, which confirms it and unlocks the next stage of the story. Each group gets its own full set of the six puzzles.

#	Players receive	Output unlocks
1	Security report (line chart)	The peak date
2	4 patrol reports + map	Safe route to the safe house
3	Folded propaganda pamphlet	Safe-house password
4	box-plot	Briefcase combination
5	Sankey transport diagram	The missing people
6	3 intel docs	Each of the three documents yields 3 values (9 in total) entered on the web component to decrypt the report

4. Solutions

Puzzle	Answer
1 Security Report	14.04
2 Patrol Map	Elli's House (Schubert Straße) → West onto Schubert Straße → Josef Straße (either directly, or via Maria Theresia Straße → Schul Ring <i>or</i> Kalcher Straße into Josef Straße) → Schießstatt Promenade (north) → Prater Straße <i>or</i> Schießstatt Ring → north across Khittel Straße, under the bridge, into Goldegger Straße, then west → Safe House.
3 Propaganda Fold	BRITAIN 1945 ● 55 ● VICTORY
4 Box Plot	6186
5 Sankey	3 Political Prisoners, 3 Saboteurs
6 Encrypted Letter	I, II, IV ● L, P, V ● 15, 16, 20

INTERNAL SECURITY ASSESSMENT

"JUSTIFICATION BRIEF FOR PREVENTIVE ACTION - ST. PÖLTEN DISTRICT"

SITUATION ASSESSMENT

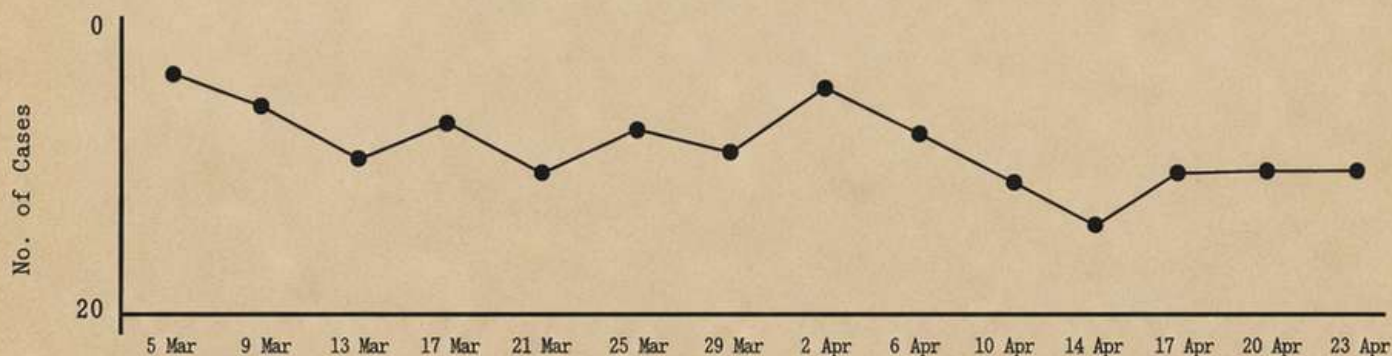
The security situation across the St. Pölten district remains firmly under the control of this office. The loyalty and discipline of the district's population continues to reflect well on the sustained efforts of enforcement personnel. Isolated elements of politically unreliable persons have been identified and handled through appropriate preventive channels.

The attached overview of recorded incidents across the reporting period demonstrates the effectiveness of the measures undertaken. The consistent application of security directives has ensured that the trajectory of recorded incidents reflects the success of this office's operations rather than any failure of control. Where elevated case numbers have been recorded, these represent the thoroughness of enforcement, not the strength of opposition.

This office is satisfied that the district remains stable and that the preventive framework in place is sufficient to address any further activity by politically unreliable persons. The work of the security service continues without interruption. Order is maintained.

CASES OF SABOTAGE, DISLOYAL CONDUCT, AND PUBLIC-ORDER THREATS - MARCH / APRIL 1945

RECORDED INCIDENTS BY REPORTING DATE



Note: Cases refer to reported incidents of sabotage, politically disloyal conduct, and other disturbances prejudicial to public order. The figures presented here are intended to provide an overview of the present security situation within the district and of the effectiveness of measures undertaken by the competent authorities. Detailed incident registers are held under file refs. SA-016/4-A through SA-016/4-I, available to authorised personnel only.

Distribution restricted to
authorised personnel only.
Destroy after use per §14-V.

J. Weismann
SS-Obersturmführer, District St. Pölten



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REICHSGAU NIEDERDONAU - SECURITY SERVICE - DISTRICT ST. PÖLTEN

PATROL REPORT

INTERNAL SECURITY - 13 APRIL 1945

PATROL LEADER

Gefreiter Otto Heinrich Suhr, acting

PATROL SIZE

2 men

TIME WINDOW

13:00 - 22:00

PATROL ZONE

Western outer approaches

PATROL SUMMARY

This report is submitted by Gefreiter Suhr. Feldwebel Ott, who led the morning shift on this sector, reported ill at approximately 12:00 and was relieved. Two men assigned to the handover patrol did not appear. Patrol of the western approaches did not resume until the afternoon. Due to insufficient strength, only selected road points along the inner western approaches could be checked.

INCIDENT LOG



PERSONS TAKEN INTO CUSTODY

6

File Ref.: SB-844/3-B

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Gefreiter Suhr, acting

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REICHSGAU NIEDERDONAU • SECURITY SERVICE • DISTRICT ST. PÖLTEN

PATROL REPORT

INTERNAL SECURITY • 13 APRIL 1945

PATROL LEADER

SS-Unterscharführer Meinhard Udo Schlatzer

PATROL SIZE

6 men

TIME WINDOW

07:00 - 12:00 • 13:00 - 22:00

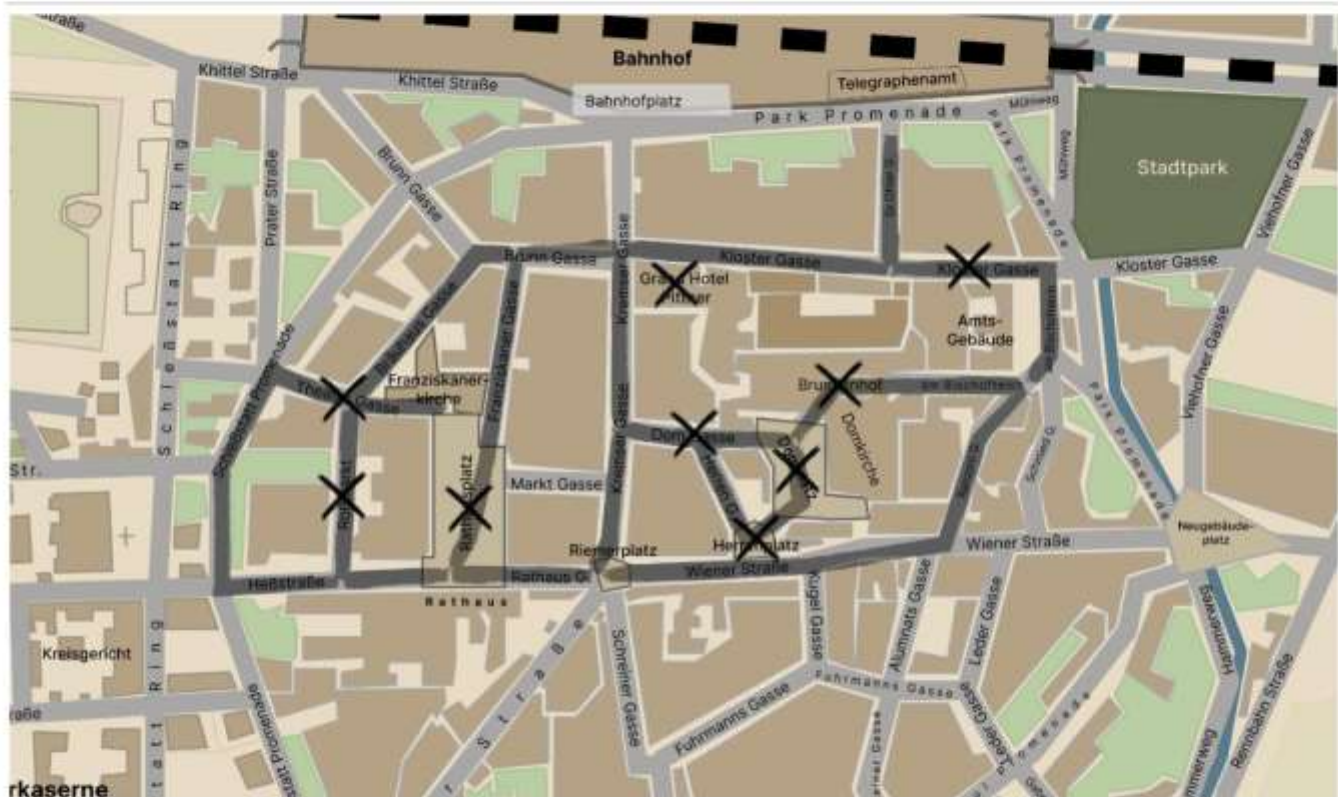
PATROL ZONE

Central administrative quarter

PATROL SUMMARY

The administrative quarter was inspected under increased security order. Patrol attention was concentrated around official buildings, church approaches, hotel entrances, and market-front passages. Visible control of the inner district was maintained throughout the day.

INCIDENT LOG



PERSONS TAKEN INTO CUSTODY

9

File Ref.: SS-944/3-A

Distribution restricted to authorized personnel only.

SS-Unterscharführer M. Schlatzer

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REICHSGAU NIEDERDONAU * SECURITY SERVICE * DISTRICT ST. PÖLTEN

PATROL REPORT

INTERNAL SECURITY * 13 APRIL 1945

PATROL LEADER
Oberwachtmeister Franz Axel GerstengrassPATROL SIZE
5 menTIME WINDOW
07:00 - 12:00 * 13:00 - 22:00PATROL ZONE
Southern school and factory quarter

PATROL SUMMARY

The southern quarter was inspected with increased vigilance following reports of movement near the factory approaches. The Waffenfabrik itself remains under permanent guard and was not included in the street patrol.

INCIDENT LOG



PERSONS TAKEN INTO CUSTODY

8

File Ref.: SB-044/3-B

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Oberwachtmeister F. Gerstengrass

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Kaiserwald

flakstellung

Hesserkaserne

Exerzierplatz

Brückensperre

Traisen Fluß

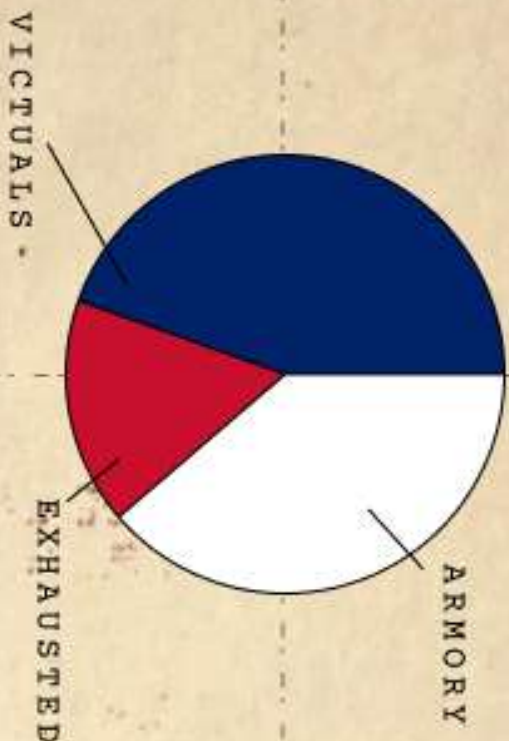
flakstellung

fronti →

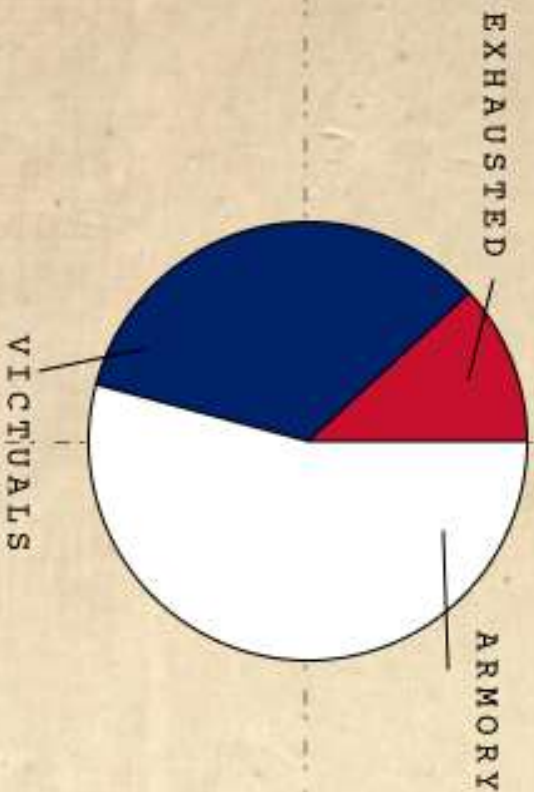
2. K. Volk

YOU ARE HERE

Britain 1940

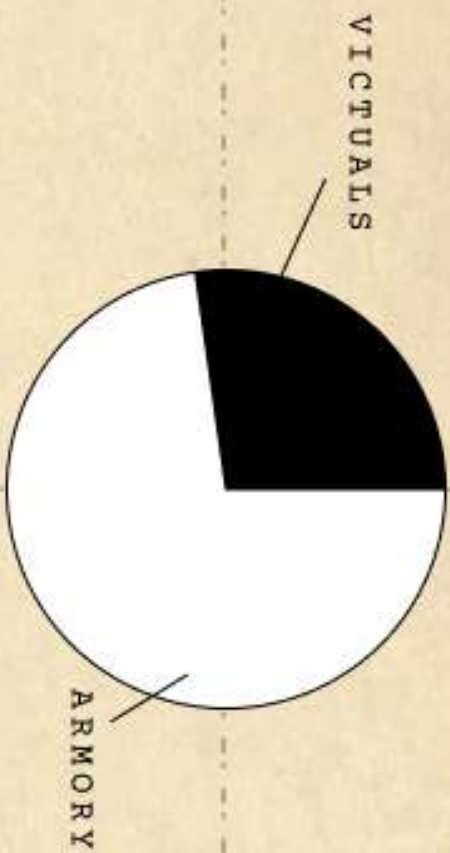


Britain 1942

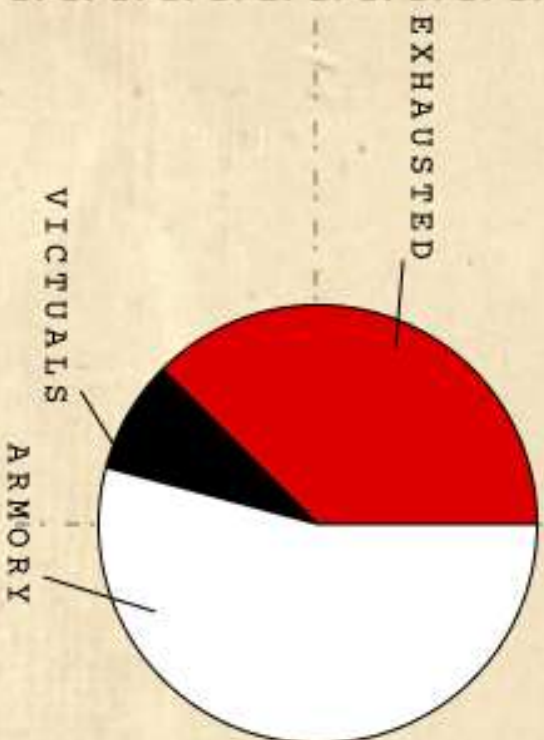


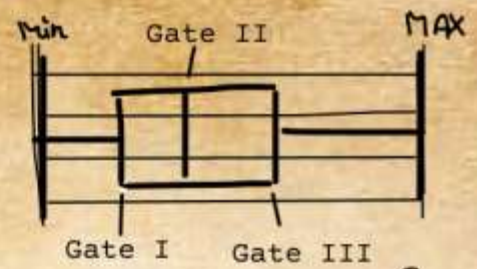
WHERE IS THE 5th PIE?
WO IST DER 5te KUCHEN?

Germany 1935



Germany 1942



Recovered Transport Record:

To open the **box**, first uncover its **plot**.

1. Order the route before judging its shape.
2. Mark the low end, the high end, and the three inner gates.
3. Only then will the plot of the box reveal which letters matter.

Route: [21, 3, 15, 9, 27, 18, 9]



Line up the route from lowest to highest.

The center marks Gate II.

Split the remaining values in two.

Each half has its own center: Gate I and Gate III.

$$e = 6$$

$$d = 5 \quad a = 22$$

$$F = 23$$

$$x = 17$$

$$c = 35$$

$$h = 20$$

$$m = 85$$

$$B = 73$$

$$i = 34$$

$$n = 12$$

$$k = 8$$

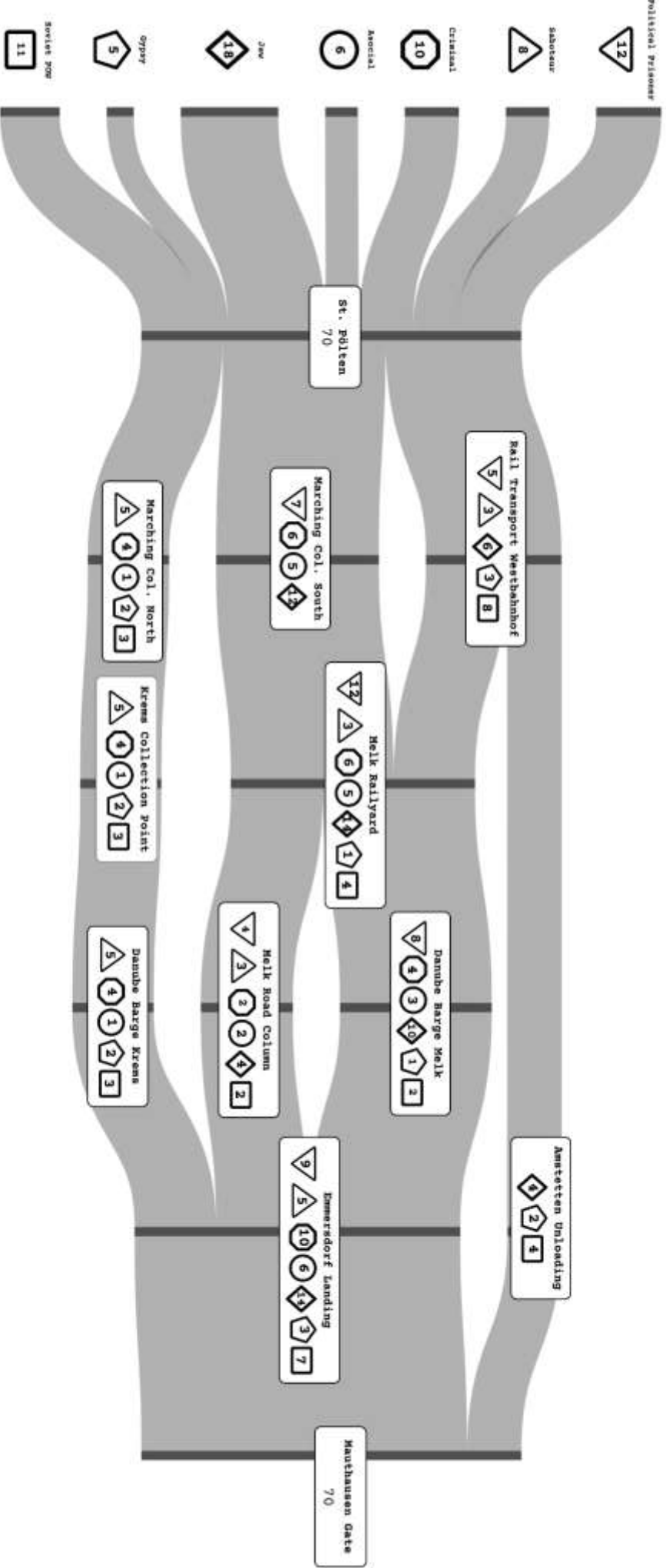
$$p = 43$$

Between Gate I and Gate II: multiply.

Between Gate II and Gate III: add.

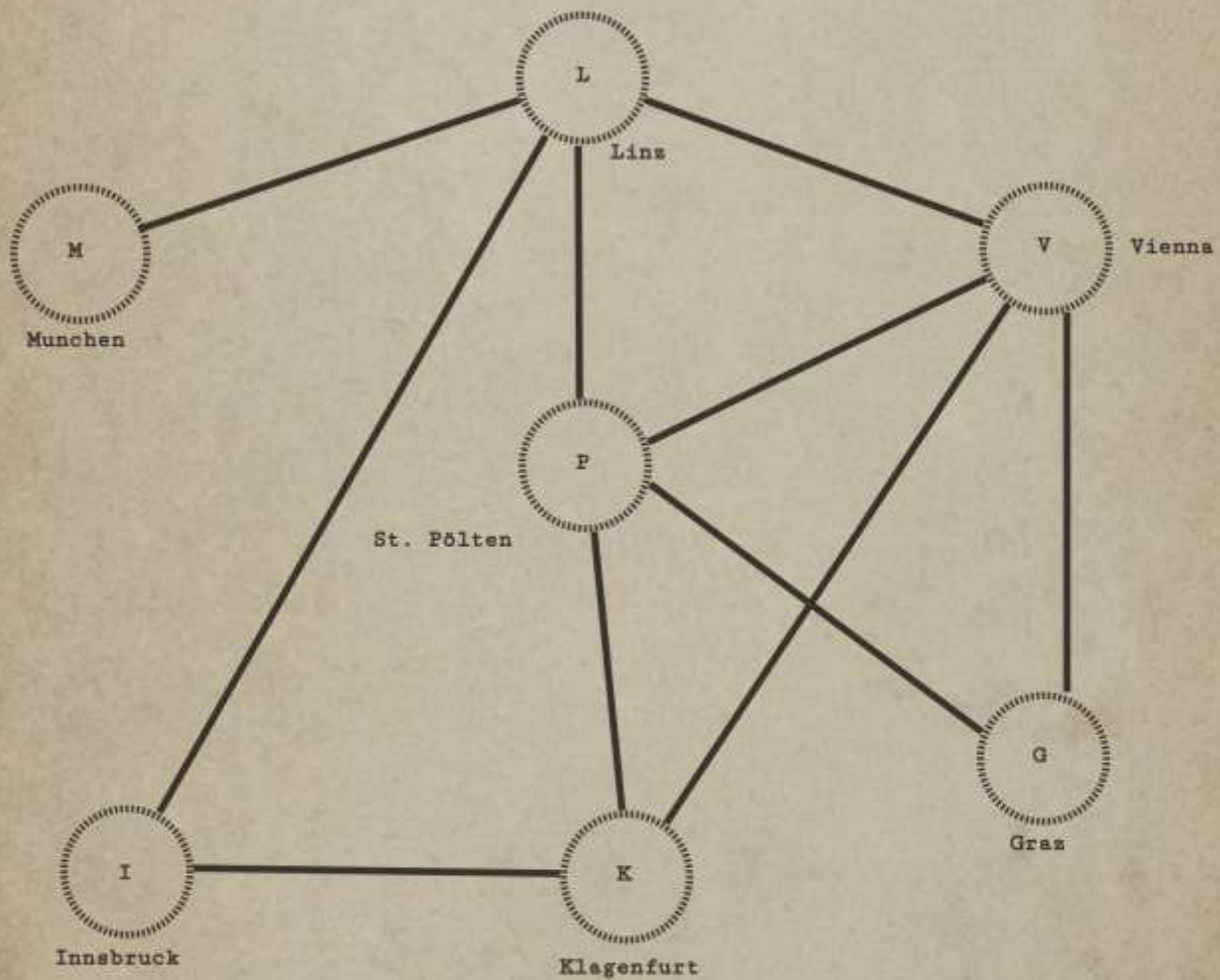
First result minus second result **opens the case**.

Prisoner Transport Report: St. Pölten to Mauthausen



By authority of the Sicherheitspolizei, the main transport record is to remain unchanged.

For completion purposes, the detached prisoners are to be carried forward in the Mauthausen Gate total until Sonderbehandlung is concluded and separate registration is completed.

DOCUMENT A - CONNECTIONS OVERVIEWCURRENTLY RELIABLE CONNECTIONS BETWEEN CITIESLEGEND

- City / Railway Station
- Reliable Connection

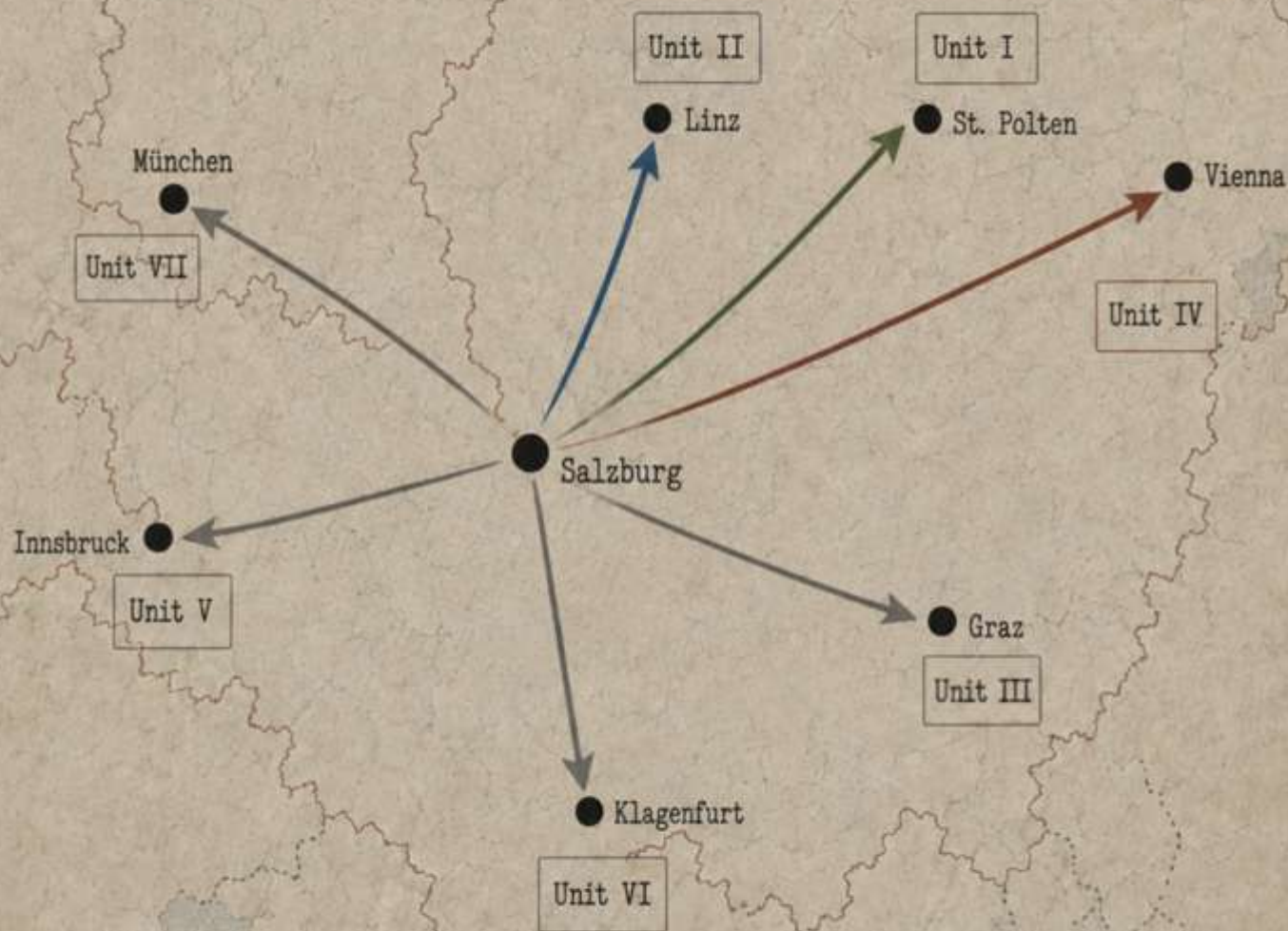
24 APR 1945

INTEL SECTION - OKH

DOCUMENT B - UNIT DEPLOYMENT FLOW

UNITS DEPLOYED FROM SALZBURG

APRIL 1945



LEGEND

→ Units deployed from Salzburg to

GEHEIM!

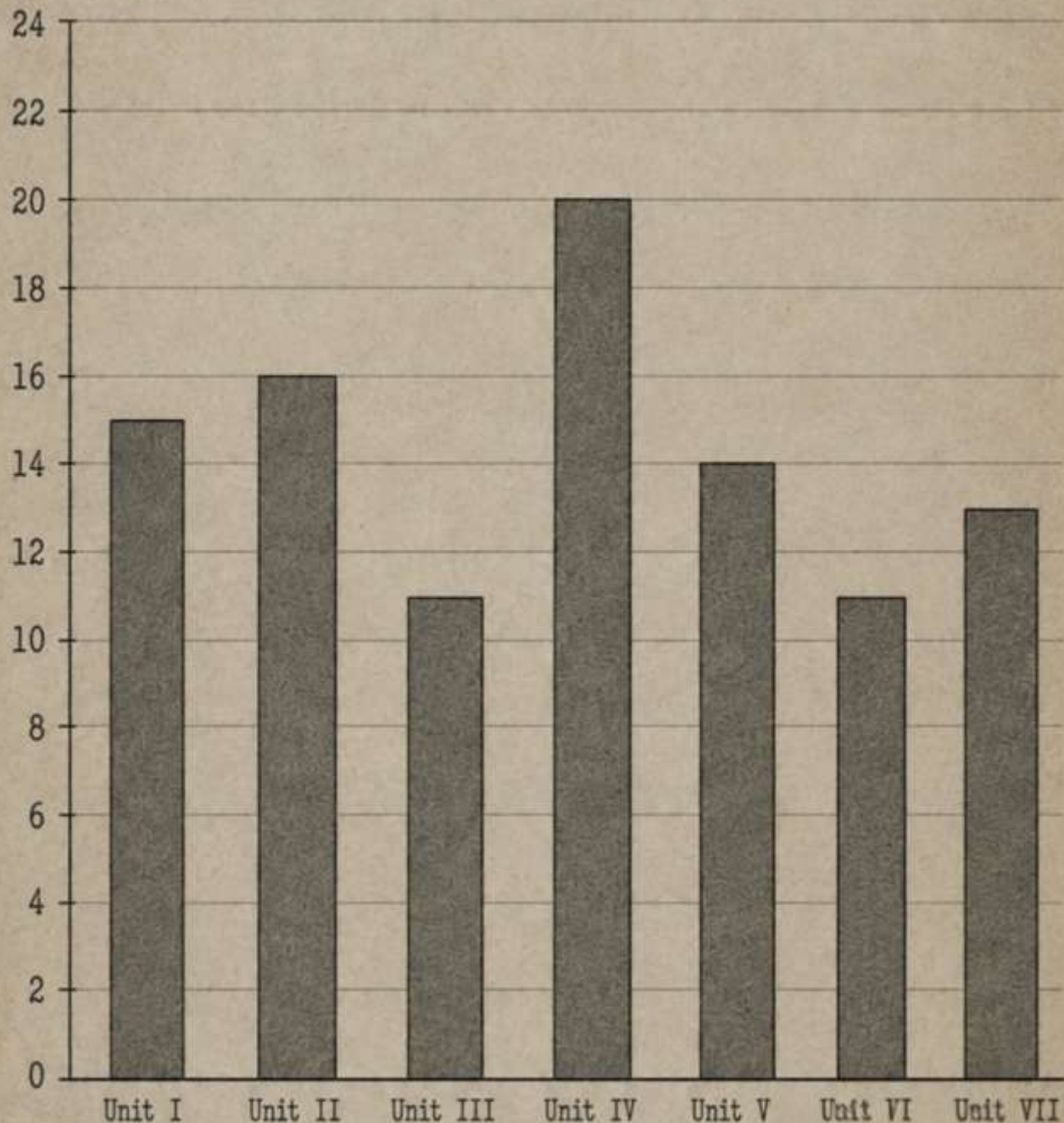
Nur für den Dienstgebrauch

24 APR 1945

DOCUMENT C - ARMOR ALLOCATIONNUMBER OF TANKS DEPLOYED PER UNIT

APRIL 1945

NUMBER OF TANKS



NOTE: Figures represent confirmed operational tanks assigned to each unit.

24 APR 1945

OKH / Wa Prüf 7

REICHsverwaltung NIEDERDONAU
Prisoner Transfer Registry
Date: 22 April 1945
Classification: GEHEIM

The following document records the reassignment of detainees from regional holding facilities to various labor and processing camps.

Due to increasing instability in the region, transport routes have been altered. Some records have been partially removed for security purposes.

Only authorized personnel may access full destination data.

Transport Registry - Reference IDs

Reg. Nr.	Name	Destination
48291	Dieter Baum	
51711	Greta Moser	
49844	Wilhelm Adler	
53367	Sofia Brandt	
60012	Elias Richter	
60059	Klaus Hofer	

ARCHIVE FILE 7B-442
VERIFIED: 23 APR 1945